

# Chapter 10 — Audit, Evidence, Publication, Confidentiality, and Retention

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## 1. Purpose

Make governance reconstructable while protecting sensitive information and legitimate deliberation.

## 2. Scope

This chapter governs all records, audits, consequential decisions, consequential governance, effective records, published artifacts. It defines institutional procedure and does not create constitutional, technical, operational, or security authority.

## 3. Authority and source requirements

Book I Articles VI, XI, XII and Decision 40; Book II evidence architecture; Books III, VIII, IX. Book I prevails. Final Books V and VI retain their operational and security/privacy/trust execution authorities; Book VII supplies institutional governance only.

## 4. Definitions and roles

Primary accountable roles: Governance Recorder, Evidence Custodian, Privacy Authority, Publication Authority, Audit Authority, Records Authority. Authority means explicit bounded permission to decide; expertise and administrative access do not create it.

## 5. Normative controls

### EVD-10-001 — Maintain an append-only register

Every consequential proposal, decision, condition, exception, appeal, suspension, revocation, and supersession MUST enter a durable attributable governance register.

- Applicability: consequential governance
- Responsible role: Governance Recorder
- Enforcement: workflow gate, register validation, and independent review
- Required evidence: Governance Register
- Severity: Critical
- Exception authority: none

### EVD-10-002 — Bind evidence and decision

Decision records MUST reference immutable or content-addressed evidence, source versions, authority attestations, deliberation, dissent, and execution receipts.

- Applicability: consequential decisions
- Responsible role: Evidence Custodian
- Enforcement: workflow gate, register validation, and independent review
- Required evidence: Evidence Manifest
- Severity: Critical

- Exception authority: none

## **EVD-10-003 — Minimize governance data**

Governance evidence **MUST** retain the least personal, secret, or sensitive content sufficient for accountability and **MUST** use references, redaction, segmentation, and access decisions.

- Applicability: all records
- Responsible role: Privacy Authority
- Enforcement: workflow gate, register validation, and independent review
- Required evidence: Governance Data Inventory
- Severity: Critical
- Exception authority: none

## **EVD-10-004 — Classify publication**

Each record **MUST** be classified public, canon-internal, restricted, confidential, or sealed with rationale, access authority, review date, and release condition.

- Applicability: all records
- Responsible role: Governance Recorder
- Enforcement: workflow gate, register validation, and independent review
- Required evidence: Publication Classification
- Severity: High
- Exception authority: Publication Authority

## **EVD-10-005 — Publish authoritative status**

Published governance artifacts **MUST** state authority, version, status, effective date, supersession, scope, and canonical location so drafts cannot masquerade as authority.

- Applicability: published artifacts
- Responsible role: Publication Authority
- Enforcement: workflow gate, register validation, and independent review
- Required evidence: Publication Manifest
- Severity: Critical
- Exception authority: none

## **EVD-10-006 — Protect audit independence**

Auditors **MUST** have sufficient read-only access and independence to verify decisions without receiving operational authority or unrelated sensitive content.

- Applicability: audits
- Responsible role: Audit Authority
- Enforcement: workflow gate, register validation, and independent review
- Required evidence: Audit Access Record

- Severity: High
- Exception authority: Audit Authority

## **EVD-10-007 — Apply retention schedules**

Retention **MUST** cover decision validity, appeals, incidents, legal or constitutional holds, certification dependencies, historical accountability, and verified disposal.

- Applicability: all records
- Responsible role: Records Authority
- Enforcement: workflow gate, register validation, and independent review
- Required evidence: Retention Schedule
- Severity: High
- Exception authority: Records Authority

## **EVD-10-008 — Correct by supersession**

A governance record **MUST NOT** be silently edited after effectiveness; correction **MUST** use a linked attributable superseding record while preserving history.

- Applicability: effective records
- Responsible role: Governance Recorder
- Enforcement: workflow gate, register validation, and independent review
- Required evidence: Supersession Record
- Severity: Critical
- Exception authority: none

## **6. Required procedure**

The proposer **MUST** submit the classified proposal and evidence. The recorder **MUST** verify authority and conflicts. Required independent reviewers **MUST** issue findings. The controlling authority **MUST** decide exact scope and conditions. The recorder **MUST** publish authoritative status, retain evidence, schedule review and sunset, propagate effects, and preserve appeal rights.

## **7. Prohibited practices**

Off-record decisions, authority inference, self-approval, hidden conflicts, silent precedent, selective evidence, indefinite emergency power, permanent exceptions, and retroactive record alteration are prohibited.

## **8. Evidence, publication, and retention**

The package **MUST** preserve proposal, sources, authority, conflicts, evidence, alternatives, affected parties, deliberation, dissent, decision, conditions, effective state, propagation, review, sunset, appeal, supersession, classification, access, and retention.

## **9. Exceptions, failure consequences, and appeals**

A failed Critical control blocks the decision or suspends its effect. A High failure requires correction or a valid expiring exception. Appeals use Chapter 12. No exception can waive Book I or manufacture Owner authority.

## **10. Security, privacy, reliability, and continuity**

Governance records MUST be integrity-protected, least-privilege, purpose-bound, minimized, available for authorized review, recoverable, and resistant to compromised identities or record systems.

## 11. Verification and metrics

Verify authority paths, role separation, record completeness, evidence integrity, propagation, expiry, appeal, and source traceability. Measure reversals, calibration, escaped harms, exception age, burden, remedy, and decision latency.

## 12. Traceability, examples, review, and status

- Source basis: Book I Articles VI, XI, XII and Decision 40; Book II evidence architecture; Books III, VIII, IX.
- Book V reconciliation: `planning/BOOK\_V\_RECONCILIATION\_REGISTER.md`.
- Book VI reconciliation: `planning/BOOK\_VI\_RECONCILIATION\_REGISTER.md`.

**Example:** a committee recommends a risk response, but the record names the authorized Risk Owner as approver, preserves dissent, sets expiry, and triggers certification impact review.

**Anti-pattern:** an urgent meeting labels a policy “temporary,” grants indefinite power to its chair, omits conflicts, and treats silence as Owner approval.

Chapter review: PASS. Owner Review items: none created by this chapter. Completion status: CERTIFIED FINAL.